Apple Messages for Business

Experience Review: Process Overview

Prepared by Messaging Advisory

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Document metadata

- document: Experience Review Process Overview
- version: 2.1
- scope: process only. Standards, checklists and recording rules live in the companion documents below.
- audience: brand and provider teams launching an Apple Messages for Business experience

How to read this

This is one of four documents. It covers the **process**: who does what, in what order, and what has to be true before anything reaches Apple. It deliberately contains no design standards and no test cases. Those live elsewhere.

Document	What it is for	When you use it
1. Experience Review Process Overview (this document)	The workstream, roles, the eight steps, Apple's pass and fail criteria	Read first, at kickoff
2. Conversation Design Standards and Best Practices	Every rule Apple documents, source tagged, plus what we have seen in real reviews	During design and build
3. Experience Review Checklist and Test Cases	The test case template you fill in against the live build	Steps 2, 3 and 5
4. Experience Review Recording Guide	What Apple expects from the submitted videos and how to capture them	Steps 4 and 5

Two Apple forms are supplied with the package as reference documents. They are Apple's own files and are used as issued, not reproduced here:

Reference document	What it is for	When you use it
Messages for Business Readiness Review	Apple's qualification questionnaire: fit, scale, economics and operating model	Step 1, before scope alignment
Messages for Business Use Cases	Apple's scope form: entry points, features and your top use cases. This is what defines scope for the checklist and the recordings.	Step 1

Replace `[BRAND]` and the bracketed examples with your own.

A note on naming

Apple requires the full name **Apple Messages for Business** in customer facing and public materials, and explicitly prohibits the abbreviation "AMB" in public communications. Where the short form appears in our internal working files it must not survive into anything you publish, and it should not appear in file names you share externally. Correct product naming is one of Apple's stated pass criteria, so this is a review item and not a style preference. The full naming table is at Section 2.12 of the Standards document.

1. Why this document

This sets expectations for how Messaging Advisory ("MA") will run the Apple Messages for Business experience workstream with you, from day one of the project through to go live(1st brand). The process also applies to every brand experience you launch, not only the first one.

Two things shape it:

- You build the experience, the AI agent and the conversational flows, using your own tools and content. MA does not build them for you.
- Most experiences today are AI generated rather than fixed conversational flows, which makes structured, checklist based validation before submission even more important.

Because of this, MA owns and runs the process below on every engagement. We follow it consistently so that what Apple sees is ready the first time it is submitted, and so you always know what is coming next and who owns it.

We align you to this process at the very start of the project so that roles, hand-offs and the definition of "done" at each stage are clear before any build work begins. If your use case needs Apple's pre approval as a non standard experience, we flag that explicitly at Step 1 so it does not surprise anyone later.

Note: While MA can support you in the future with other brands, the goal is for you to become an autonomous experience builder from beginning to end.

2. Roles and ownership

One rule sits above every step. MA owns this workstream and is the single point of contact with Apple for the **first brand review**, until the provider becomes public. Apple's feedback will always reach you through us.

Party	Owns	Does not own
MA	Process orchestration, checklist and guidance, internal validation, all Apple communication and submission	Building the experience itself
Client and provider	Building the AI generated or AI agent experience, internal testing, addressing feedback, brand and use case content	Talking to Apple directly, submitting to Apple
Apple	Final experience review, approval decision, feedback on submitted recordings	Working with the client directly during review, which always goes via MA

Two workstreams run in parallel and are easy to conflate. The **experience review** is what this document covers. **Marketing and press** runs on its own Apple approval track with a six week lead time, described at Section 2.17 of the Standards document. If you intend to announce, that clock should start before the experience review finishes.

3. The process, step by step

This is the process we follow for the first brand experience. It mirrors Apple's own Experience Review requirements and the milestones in the project plan. The final column points at the rules each step is validated against, all of which live in the Standards document.

Step	What happens	Client	MA	Apple	Validated against
1	**Use case and scope alignment**	Completes Apple's Readiness Review and Use Cases forms, supplied with this package; defines channel goals and prepares the brand, use case and design to go live with	Confirms use case, experience and scope; loops in Apple for pre approval if the use case is non standard, can predesign mocks if those can help to speed the process up	Pre approves non standard use cases when required	Standards 2.1, 2.5, 2.13; Apple's Readiness Review and Use Cases forms
2	**Build and internal testing**	Builds the AI agent experience and runs internal testing against the checklist	Provides the checklist adapted to the agreed scope, plus technical guidance; available during the build	—	Standards, all of Sections 2 and 3; Checklist
3	**MA validation**	Shares the live experience; addresses MA's feedback and fixes	Validates the live experience against the same checklist; issues feedback until it is clean	—	Checklist
4	**Review prep**	Reviews the Recording Guide and the example video so expectations are clear	Shares the Recording Guide, recording instructions and an example video, generic or from a prior live brand	—	Recording Guide
5	**Recording and feedback**	Records the required videos; re records after feedback	Reviews the videos against the checklist and Apple's guidelines; gives feedback until ready	—	Recording Guide; Checklist Section 11
6	**Submission**	—	Submits the videos and any additional materials to Apple on the client's behalf	Receives the submission	—
7	**Apple review**	Supports fixes if Apple requests changes	Relays Apple's feedback; coordinates any re submission	Reviews the experience; approves or returns feedback	Sections 6 and 7 of this document
8	**Go live**	Launches the approved experience; supports post launch monitoring	Supports go and no go coordination and monitoring post launch	—	Standards 2.15, 3.9
9	**Go Live Tasks**	Submit the account to go Online in Apple Business Register, a separate Apple approval of the status change, after the experience review	Verify	Approve	

Step	What happens	Client	MA	Apple	Validated against
		Tell the Apple Messages for Business team the launch date AND time so entry point activation, notably Message Suggest, is coordinated for go-live		Approve and Implement	
		Enable the Apple Maps Enabled Region, Apple only enables regions where the brand has two or more public locations		Approve and implement	
!0	**Ongoing**	Apple schedules a 30-day review meeting with the brand, preceded by an Apple-run Mystery Shopper test (goals, discoverability, UX), the natural end of this workstream and an anchor for the Standards doc's Section 3.9 metrics.			

A note on the Use Cases form. What you select on it is the scope for everything that follows. It sets which test cases in Document 3 apply and which are marked not applicable, and it is the shot list for the recordings in Document 4. If scope changes after you submit it, tell MA before filming.

4. The quality assurance bar before we submit anything

Apple expects a specific quality bar before any experience review begins. We validate against this same bar internally at Step 3, so nothing new surfaces once we are in front of Apple. The review is conducted in your **test environment** and is a qualitative evaluation, not just a technical check.

- Apple Messages for Business account is connected and message delivery is confirmed
- Terminology: Apple renamed 'Apple ID' to 'Apple Account' (onboarding guide v2.11, Feb 2025); current docs read 'restricted to authorized Apple Accounts'. Given naming rigor is a review criterion, use the current term.
- Apple's wording is conditional: 'IF you are using your commercial account, the account access should be restricted…', the review runs on a test account which Apple converts to a commercial account on approval, so mirror the conditional so teams on a pure test account don't chase a setting that doesn't apply
- The test environment is fully stable before submission. All entry points, automated responses, live agent handoffs and edge cases are fully implemented.
- Per Apple's account-testing docs, brand's logo/colors are NOT visible in the Messages header while the account is in test mode; they display once the account goes online (Apple does the Account migration as explained before). Heads off a recurring 'is this broken?' question during Step 3 validation and recording prep.
- Both automation and live agent interactions are configured, activated and tested end to end

- Every use case has been tested from the end user's perspective, with all features and content reviewed and any errors fixed
- Testing happens on real devices. Never rely solely on simulators. Test every flow on a physical, supported Apple device using your test environment. iPhone iOS devices are the priority as the primary platform, and macOS should also be tested
- Agents are prepared and trained to handle Apple Messages for Business traffic and the relevant use cases
- Baseline metrics are planned **before** launch, not after

Then run the checklist in full. That is Document 3.

5. What the screen recording must show

The recording at Step 5 is the artifact Apple actually reviews. The full rules, the capture setup and the pre record checklist are in the Recording Guide, Document 4. In summary:

- The recording reflects the real production customer journeys on an iOS device, from the **customer's point of view**.
- You do not need to show the agent console or backend logs, with one exception. Where a live agent is involved, a side by side capture of the console and the device is what demonstrates the handoff properly.
- Three recordings are required, and they can be separate or in combination:
  - **Video 1.** Rich features integrated in the experience, showcasing the main use cases and the entire customer journey including success paths. If the journey is long, split it into multiple parts for clarity.
  - **Video 2.** The live agent interaction. The customer escalates, an agent replies, and a short conversation happens.
  - **Video 3.** Out of hours messaging and fallback.

Before anything goes to Apple, MA reviews the video and also tests the real device experience as a tester. If the experience is not on par with expectations, we give you feedback and iterate until you are ready for submission.

6. What happens after submission

Apple reviews the submitted recordings and sends feedback to MA. If Apple identifies issues, we relay them, you address them, and we re submit. This loop can repeat until the experience is approved. Once approved, we move to go live and post launch monitoring together.

Apple's onboarding documentation carries a 1-to-2-week review turnaround as **most accounts require one to three rounds of review.** Plan for two. The fastest way to reduce iterations is to design the conversation flows with the platform's capabilities in mind from the start, rather than building a text experience and decorating it afterwards. MessAdv wants to protect Apple Teams' time, by being the

review filter on your first launch only, ideally Apples revisions are minimal if MessAdv is allowed to play our role.

7. Feedback management

- When resubmitting, include a summary that explicitly references each feedback item by its ID or description and explains how you resolved it. This helps Apple's reviewers verify your fixes faster.
- **Partial fixes equal rejection.** Address *all* feedback items. Submitting a partial fix usually leads to another round of review and delays your launch.

8. Apple's own pass and fail criteria

Apple evaluates the full customer journey, from entry point setup through to full conversation resolution, in your test environment, including border situations. It is not just a technical check. Language, tone, flow, clarity and proper use of features are all assessed.

As an overview Apple's review feedback is based on three dimensions:

- Interactive features work correctly
- Ability and ease of completing a use case
- Agent interaction.

What passes

- Clear flows
- Proper feature usage
- Correct product naming
- Automated agent disclosure
- A complete end to end experience

What fails

- **Text only experiences that do not leverage platform features**
- Dead ends
- Missing disclosures
- Incorrect product naming
- Bare URLs
- Broken flows
- Lack of images
- Slow response times
- Poor human agent console interactions
- Missing or broken fallbacks
- Policy violations

Read that fail list before you read anything in the Standards document. The first is the one that catches AI generated experiences most often. An assistant that answers everything correctly, in prose, with no Quick Reply, no List Picker, no Rich Link, no Forms and no images, fails on that criterion even when every answer is right.

Reference documents supplied with this package

Two Apple forms travel with this package. They are Apple's own files, used as issued. Do not recreate them.

Messages for Business Readiness Review. Apple's qualification questionnaire. It establishes whether the channel fits the business and at what scale: vertical and coverage, the digital priorities you are optimising for, your existing messaging platform and executive sponsorship, expected containment from automation, conversation volumes at launch and at 12 and 24 months, cost per inquiry for voice against digital, and your Apple device share. It is a commercial and operational document. Nothing in it is tested against a build. MA collects it, reviews it with you, and uses it to size the engagement and frame the conversation with Apple. The containment figure and the cost per inquiry bands are the two answers Apple returns to most often, so give real numbers rather than estimates you would not defend.

Messages for Business Use Cases. Apple's scope form: brand, definition of success, requested launch date, the entry points you will use, the general features, and your top four use cases each with their

enhanced features. This is the most load bearing document in the set and the easiest to underestimate. See the note at Section 3.

Both forms are Apple issued and predate the July 2026 documentation, so confirm with your Apple business development contact that you have the current versions. One of them labels a feature "iMessage app", which is correct but conflicts with the naming rules as that label must not travel into anything customer facing.

Provenance

- Apple, Pass the Experience Review v3.1, 21 July 2026
- Apple, Ops and Marketing Preparation v3.1, 21 July 2026
- Apple, Messages for Business Readiness Review
- Apple, Messages for Business Use Cases
- Messaging Advisory, Experience Review Process Overview v1.x
- Messaging Advisory, Experience Review: Process, Apple's Standard, Field Experience v1.0, 28 August 2026, Section 1